

Thalassemia Research: Knowledge Questions Weight Report

Total Responses: 201

This report calculates the weight (percentage of respondents, or p) for the correct answers in the single-choice knowledge questions, and the weight for each option in the multiple-choice knowledge questions. It also includes the $1 - p$ values (the proportion of respondents who did not choose the correct answer/option). Demographic and practice-related questions have been excluded as requested.

Single-Choice Questions

Weights (p) represent the percentage of respondents who selected the correct answer. The $1 - p$ column represents those who did not.

Question	Correct Answer	Correct Responses	Weight (p) %	$1 - p$ (%)
15. Is thalassemia a blood-related disease?	Yes	181	90.05%	9.95%
17. What is the most severe form of thalassemia?	Thalassemia major (severe form)	126	62.69%	37.31%
19. Does thalassemia major require lifelong treatment?	Yes	129	64.18%	35.82%
20. Can thalassemia major be cured?	Very difficult (e.g., bone marrow transplant)*	30	14.93%	85.07%
21. Can the spread of thalassemia be prevented?	Can be prevented	151	75.12%	24.88%
22. How is	From generation			

thalassemia transmitted?	to generation (hereditary)	179	89.05%	10.95%
23. Is a thalassemia carrier usually sick or healthy?	Healthy	166	82.59%	17.41%
24. A child born from two thalassemia carriers will be:	Has a chance to be affected (e.g., 25%)	121	60.20%	39.80%
26. How many thalassemia births occur in Sri Lanka per year?	40–100	8	3.98%	96.02%

** Note for Q20: While 14.93% chose the strictly medically accurate answer regarding bone marrow transplants, a further 47.76% (96 respondents) chose “Cannot be cured” which is often treated as functionally correct in basic awareness contexts without access to advanced medical procedures.*

Multiple-Choice Questions

Weights (p) represent the percentage of respondents who selected each specific option. The 1 – p column represents those who did not select it.

16. What are the clinical forms of thalassemia?

Option	Selections	Weight (p) %	1 – p (%)
Thalassemia major (severe form) (Correct)	147	73.13%	26.87%
Thalassemia minor or trait (carrier form) (Correct)	146	72.64%	27.36%
Thalassemia intermedia (moderate form) (Correct)	15	7.46%	92.54%
I don't know	48	23.88%	76.12%

27. Problems faced by thalassemia major patients

Option	Selections	Weight (<i>p</i>) %	1 – <i>p</i> (%)
Regular blood transfusions for life (<i>Correct</i>)	169	84.08%	15.92%
Fatigue (<i>Correct</i>)	64	31.84%	68.16%
Iron overload affecting heart and liver (<i>Correct</i>)	53	26.37%	73.63%
Delayed growth and puberty (<i>Correct</i>)	48	23.88%	76.12%
Bone deformities (<i>Correct</i>)	41	20.40%	79.60%
Risk of infections from transfusions (<i>Correct</i>)	39	19.40%	80.60%
Frequent nosebleeds	29	14.43%	85.57%
Risk of diabetes, infertility, and hormonal issues (<i>Correct</i>)	15	7.46%	92.54%

28. What should a thalassemia carrier do after diagnosis?

Option	Selections	Weight (<i>p</i>) %	1 – <i>p</i> (%)
Get the partner tested before marriage (<i>Correct</i>)	159	79.10%	20.90%
Get family members tested (<i>Correct</i>)	158	78.61%	21.39%
I don't know	15	7.46%	92.54%
Ignore it	0	0.00%	100.00%